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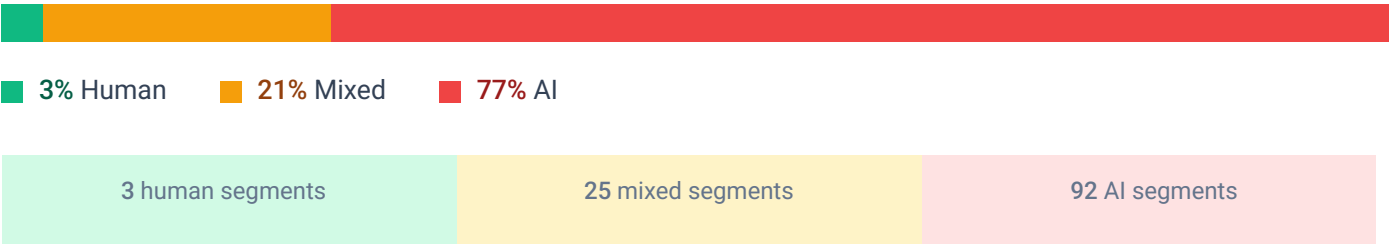
120

TEXT SEGMENTS

ARMOR
Progress
Report
(April
2026).docx

SOURCE FILE

COMPOSITION BREAKDOWN



SENTENCE-LEVEL HEATMAP

How to read: Text highlighted in **red** is flagged as AI-generated. Text in **yellow** is mixed. Unhighlighted text is assessed as human-written.

April 2026

APRIL MONTHLY PROGRESS REPORT

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

1.0 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The month of April 2026 focused on advancing ongoing verification activities, strengthening stakeholder coordination, and operationalizing the Verification Task Management System (VTMS) to support structured reviews of verification outcomes.

During the reporting period, the Independent Verification Agent (IVA) continued the assessment of Disbursement-Linked Results (DLRs) based on available and incoming evidence while maintaining follow-up engagements with key institutions to address outstanding documentation gaps.

A major milestone during the month was the onboarding of the Program Coordination Unit (PCU) and the World Bank Task Team on the VTMS.

This included a system walkthrough during the weekly engagement session, and a dedicated hands-on onboarding session held on 24th April 2026, where stakeholders were guided through the platform using their individual login credentials.

This activity marked a critical transition from internal verification processes to a structured, transparent, and system-driven review environment.

In parallel, the IVA continued verification of DLIs/DLRs using the approved Test Procedures and Master Score Sheet, while progressively uploading validated results into the VTMS.

Follow-up engagements were also sustained with the Nigeria Customs Service (NCS) to obtain outstanding evidence required to complete verification for relevant DLRs.

Overall, April activities reflect steady progress in verification execution, improved stakeholder alignment, and

the operationalization of the digital verification platform to support auditability and structured review.

Key Achievements (April 2026)

Onboarded the PCU and World Bank onto the Verification Task Management System (VTMS).

Conducted system walkthrough and hands-on training session on 24th April 2026.

Continued verification of DLIs/DLRs based on available and incoming evidence.

Uploaded validated results on the VTMS for structured review.

Followed up with the Nigeria Customs Service (NCS) on outstanding documentation.

Next Steps (May 2026)

Follow up with relevant agencies to obtain outstanding documentation.

Continue verification of DLIs/DLRs based on incoming evidence.

Complete validation of partially assessed DLRs upon receipt of full evidence.

Support structured review of uploaded results within the VTMS.

KEY ACTIVITIES

2.0 KEY ACTIVITIES

During the month of April 2026, the Independent Verification Agent (IVA) continued the execution phase of the ARMOR verification engagement, with activities focused on advancing verification assessments, strengthening stakeholder engagement, and operationalizing the Verification Test Management System (VTMS).

The IVA continued verification activities through the application of the approved Test Procedures, while progressively transitioning validated results into the VTMS to enable structured stakeholder review.

In parallel, engagements with key institutions were maintained to address outstanding data gaps and ensure completeness of evidence required for verification.

A key highlight was the successful onboarding of the PCU and World Bank onto the VTMS, marking a significant step toward enhancing transparency, traceability, and structured review within the verification process.

The key activities undertaken during the month are outlined below:

2.1 Onboarding of PCU and World Bank on the Verification Task Management System (VTMS)

The IVA successfully onboarded the Program Coordination Unit (PCU) and the World Bank Task Team onto the Verification Task Management System (VTMS).

This activity marked a critical step in transitioning from internal verification processes to a structured, transparent, and system-driven review environment.

The onboarding process was conducted in two stages.

First, the IVA facilitated a live system walkthrough during the weekly engagement meeting, providing stakeholders with an overview of the platform's structure, functionalities, and verification workflow.

This was followed by a dedicated hands-on onboarding session held on 24th April 2026, where PCU

representatives were guided through the system using their individual login credentials.

The sessions focused on building stakeholder familiarity with the platform, demonstrating how verification results are documented and reviewed, and clarifying roles within the system to support effective oversight and feedback.

The onboarding covered:

Navigation of the VTMS interface and dashboard.

Review of uploaded verification results and supporting evidence.

Understanding reviewer roles, comment features, and feedback workflows.

Demonstration of audit trail, version control, and tracking functionalities.

Clarification of review timelines and expectations.

2.2 Follow-Up with Nigeria Customs Service (NCS) on Outstanding Documentation

The IVA continued follow-up engagements with the Nigeria Customs Service (NCS) to obtain outstanding documentation required for verification.

This follows earlier delays resulting from changes in designated focal persons within the agency.

The engagement focused on re-establishing coordination channels, facilitating introductions to the newly assigned focal team, and reiterating the outstanding data requirements necessary for completing verification assessments linked to NCS-related DLIs/DLRs.

This activity is critical to ensuring completeness of evidence and enabling the IVA to finalize pending verification outcomes.

The follow-up focused on:

Re-establishing engagement with newly designated NCS focal persons

Communicating outstanding evidence requirements

Aligning on timelines for submission of pending documentation

Ensuring continuity in coordination and data exchange

2.3 Continued Verification of DLIs/DLRs

The IVA continued the verification of Disbursement-Linked Indicators (DLIs) and Disbursement-Linked Results (DLRs) based on available and incoming evidence.

This activity builds on the verification work initiated in March and focuses on progressing assessments toward completion.

Verification was conducted using the approved Test Procedures and Master Score Sheet, ensuring consistency, objectivity, and alignment with the Verification Protocol.

Where sufficient evidence was available, DLRs were validated, while partially complete assessments were documented and flagged for follow-up.

The verification process involved:

Reviewing newly submitted evidence from relevant institutions

Applying approved Test Procedures to assess DLR achievement

Updating assessment outcomes within the Master Score Sheet

Identifying and documenting gaps where evidence remains outstanding

2.4 Upload of Validated Results on the VTMS

As part of the transition to a system-driven verification process, the IVA commenced the upload of validated verification results into the Verification Task Management System (VTMS).

This activity ensures that all verified outcomes are formally documented within a centralized platform for structured review and audit tracking.

The upload process followed internal validation at the Master Score Sheet level, ensuring that only quality-assured results were migrated into the system.

This approach maintains data integrity and supports transparency in the verification process.

The upload process involved:

Finalizing validated results at the Master Score Sheet level

Uploading corresponding evidence and assessment outputs into the VTMS

Ensuring proper linkage between evidence, DLRs, and verification outcomes

NEXT STEPS

3.0 NEXT STEPS (MAY 2026)

Following progress made in April, the focus for May 2026 will be on completing ongoing verification activities, strengthening evidence completeness, and advancing structured stakeholder review within the Verification Test Management System (VTMS).

The next phase will emphasize finalization of pending assessments, resolution of outstanding data gaps, and effective utilization of the system for review and feedback.

The planned next steps are outlined below:

3.1 Continued Stakeholder Engagement and Data Follow-Up

The IVA will continue targeted engagements with relevant institutions to obtain outstanding documentation required to complete the verification process.

This will involve sustained follow-up with agencies where evidence gaps have been identified.

These engagements will focus on ensuring timely submission of pending evidence, clarifying outstanding data requirements, and strengthening coordination mechanisms to support efficient data exchange.

This step remains critical, ensuring that all verification conclusions are supported by complete, accurate, and compliant evidence.

These engagements will focus on:

Following up on pending evidence submissions across relevant agencies

Clarifying outstanding data requirements linked to specific DLIs/DLRs

Addressing gaps identified during the initial evidence review process

Strengthening coordination with focal people to ensure timely data exchange

3.2 Continuation and Completion of Verification Activities

Building on the verification work carried out in March and April, the IVA will continue the assessment of DLRs using the approved Test Procedures and Master Score Sheet, with a strong focus on completing ongoing evaluations.

Emphasis will be placed on finalizing DLRs that were previously assessed but remain incomplete due to outstanding documentation.

As additional evidence is received, the IVA will update assessment outcomes, validate results, and ensure that all findings are fully aligned with the Verification Protocol and supported by adequate documentation.

This will involve:

Continuing verification of DLRs based on incoming evidence.

Completing the validation of partially assessed DLRs upon receipt of full documentation.

Ensuring consistent application of verification procedures across all assessments.

3.3 Review of Results on the VTMS

Following the onboarding of the PCU and World Bank on the VTMS, the IVA will support the structured review of uploaded verification results within the platform.

This will involve facilitating stakeholder access, addressing feedback, and ensuring that the review process is conducted efficiently and transparently.

The IVA will also ensure that all uploaded results maintain a clear audit trail, with proper linkage between evidence, assessment outcomes, and verification conclusions.

This will enhance transparency, accountability, and confidence in the verification process.

CONCLUSION

4.0 CONCLUSION

The month of April 2026 marked a significant step in operationalizing the verification process under the ARMOR Program.

The successful onboarding of the PCU and World Bank onto the Verification Task Management System (VTMS) represents a key milestone in enhancing transparency, collaboration, and structured review of verification results.

In parallel, the IVA sustained verification activities and continued stakeholder engagements to address outstanding data gaps, particularly with the Nigeria Customs Service.

The progressive upload of validated results on the VTMS further demonstrates the transition from internal assessment to a fully auditable and system-driven verification process.

As the engagement progresses into May, the focus will be on completing outstanding verification activities, strengthening evidence completeness, and advancing stakeholder review within the VTMS.

The IVA remains committed to delivering a rigorous, transparent, and evidence-based verification process that supports credible and defensible disbursement decisions.

METHODOLOGY & DISCLAIMER

About This Analysis

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Report Verification

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